

SPIRAL RAISES — WOLPERT

Opener may raise responder's major to 2M on 3- OR 4-card support. Responder then asks with the cheapest step, and opener spirals out support length, strength, and shortness.

(Wolpert: Spiral Raises.)

After 1♦ 1♥ 2♥, responder asks with 2♣. Opener answers:

- 2N 3-card support, balanced, minimum
- 3♣ 4-card support, balanced
- 3♦ 3-card support, short in the other minor (♣)
- 3♥ 3-card support, short in the other major (♠)
- 3♠ 4-card support, splinter in ♣
- 3N 3-card support, balanced, maximum
- 4♣ 4-card support, splinter in the other minor (♠)
- 4♦ 5-4-2-2, maximum
- 4♥ 5-4-2-2, minimum

(5-4-2-2 means five in the opened minor with four-card support.)

After 1m 1♠ 2♠ the ask is 2N, the same scheme shifted up a step.

A 1♠ opening mirrors 1♦ with the minors swapped.

<https://bridgewinners.com/article/view/spiral-raises/>